SYNTHETIC – FOR RESEARCH AND TESTING ONLY

Sardar Patel Institute of Technology (SPIT)
Academic Year 2026–27

Library Rules and Regulations

Central Library (Learning Resource Centre)

Field	Details
Document ID	SPIT-CA-LIB-2026-01
Document Title	Library Rules and Regulations
Issuing Department	Central Library (Learning Resource Centre)
Approving Authority	Director, on the recommendation of the Library Advisory Committee (meeting dated 28 May 2026)
Version	4.0
Publication Date	15 June 2026
Effective Date	1 July 2026
Supersedes	SPIT-CA-LIB-2024-02 (Library Rules and Regulations, Version 3.1, effective 1 July 2024)
Applicable To	All students (UG, PG, PhD), faculty, staff, alumni members and external members of the Central Library
Next Review Date	31 May 2027
Category	Campus and Administration
Keywords	library, membership, borrowing limit, loan period, renewal, overdue fine, lost book, e-resources, remote access, discussion room, book bank, no-dues, similarity check

Disclaimer. This is a fictional, synthetic document created solely to test a retrieval-augmented College Information Chatbot (research prototype). It does not represent, reproduce or summarise any actual policy of Sardar Patel Institute of Technology. All names, figures, dates, contact details and procedures are invented.

1. Purpose and Scope

1.1 These rules govern the use of the Central Library (also called the Learning Resource Centre, LRC) of Sardar Patel Institute of Technology, its reading halls, digital library, discussion rooms and electronic resources. They apply to every person who enters the library premises or uses its print or electronic collections.

1.2 These rules replace the Library Rules and Regulations, Version 3.1 (SPIT-CA-LIB-2024-02). A summary of the changes is given in Section 14. Where any older notice displayed in the library differs from this document, this document prevails from 1 July 2026.

1.3 Misconduct in the library that is not covered by a library fine (for example, theft or mutilation of material, misuse of another person's identity card or abusive behaviour towards staff) is dealt with under the Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules (SPIT-CA-COC-2026-01).

2. Location and Facilities

2.1 The Central Library occupies the ground and first floors of the Library Block. The ground floor houses the Circulation Counter, the Lending Section, the Reference Section and the Periodicals Section. The first floor houses the Main Reading Hall (180 seats), the Digital Library (60 computer

terminals), four bookable Group Discussion Rooms (DR-1 to DR-4, six seats each) and the Silent Study Zone (40 seats).

2.2 The library holds approximately 62,000 printed volumes, 1,450 bound journal volumes, 95 print periodical subscriptions and access to the electronic resources listed in Section 9.

Facility	Location	Capacity	Notes
Circulation Counter	Ground floor	–	Issue, return, renewal, reservations
Reference Section	Ground floor	40 seats	Reference books are for in-library use only
Main Reading Hall	First floor	180 seats	Personal books allowed after registration at entry
Silent Study Zone	First floor	40 seats	Complete silence; no group study
Digital Library	First floor	60 terminals	Login with institute credentials
Group Discussion Rooms DR-1 to DR-4	First floor	6 seats each	Bookable, see Section 8
24x7 Reading Room	Library Block annexe	80 seats	No lending; open only to current students and faculty

3. Library Timings

3.1 The library follows the timings below. Timings on the day before a public holiday remain normal unless notified on the library notice board and the Student Portal.

Section	Monday–Friday	Saturday	Sunday and public holidays
Circulation Counter (issue/return)	09:00 – 18:00	09:00 – 14:00	Closed
Main Reading Hall and Reference Section	08:00 – 21:00	09:00 – 17:00	Closed
Digital Library	09:00 – 20:00	09:00 – 14:00	Closed
24x7 Reading Room	Open 24 hours	Open 24 hours	Open 24 hours

3.2 **Extended hours during examinations.** During the end-semester examination period notified in the Academic Calendar, and during the seven calendar days immediately preceding it, the Main Reading Hall remains open from 08:00 to 23:00 on all days, including Sundays. The Circulation Counter timings do not change.

3.3 Entry to the Main Reading Hall closes 30 minutes before its closing time. Books must be returned to the counter or the drop box before leaving.

3.4 **Book drop box.** A self-return drop box is available outside the library entrance at all times. Books placed in the drop box are checked in on the next working day; any fine accrues only up to the date the box is emptied, and items dropped on or before the due date are not fined.

4. Membership

4.1 Every student enrolled for 2026–27 is automatically a member of the library. The student's RFID identity card issued by the institute serves as the library card. No separate library card is issued.

4.2 A student must activate library membership by visiting the Circulation Counter once with the identity card during the first 30 days of the semester; this links the card to the library management system. Faculty and staff membership is activated by the Establishment Section on joining.

4.3 Membership categories and their privileges are given below.

Member category	Maximum books on loan	Loan period	Renewals allowed	Reserved books
UG student (FE, SE, TE, BE)	4	14 days	2	2
PG student (M.Tech, MCA)	6	21 days	2	3
PhD scholar	10	30 days	3	4
Faculty	15	90 days (one semester)	2	5
Non-teaching staff	3	30 days	1	1
Alumni member	2	14 days	1	1
External member (approved institutions)	2	14 days	1	0

4.4 **Alumni membership.** Alumni may become members on payment of ₹1,500 per year and a refundable deposit of ₹3,000. Alumni membership is valid from 1 July to 30 June.

4.5 **External membership.** Faculty and research scholars of other institutions may be granted reference-only membership for up to six months on a recommendation letter from their institution and payment of ₹1,000. Borrowing privileges for external members require additional approval by the Librarian.

4.6 A library card (identity card) is not transferable. Books issued on a card are the responsibility of the card holder. A member who loses the identity card must report the loss at the Circulation Counter immediately so that it is blocked; the member is liable for any books issued on the card before the loss was reported.

5. Borrowing, Return and Renewal

5.1 **Issue.** Books are issued only at the Circulation Counter or at the two self-issue kiosks on the ground floor, on presentation of the member's own identity card. A member may not borrow more than one copy of the same title at a time.

5.2 **Due date.** The due date is printed on the issue slip and sent by e-mail to the member's institute e-mail address. If the due date falls on a Sunday or a public holiday, it is extended to the next working day.

5.3 **Renewal.** A book may be renewed at the counter, at a kiosk or online through the library catalogue (OPAC) on or before the due date, up to the number of times shown in Section 4.3. A book cannot be renewed if another member has reserved it or if the member has an unpaid fine of more than ₹100.

5.4 **Reservation.** A member may reserve a book that is currently on loan. When the book is returned, it is held at the counter for three working days for the member who reserved it, after which the reservation lapses.

5.5 **Recall.** The Librarian may recall any book before its due date if it is required for a semester-end examination reserve, an accreditation audit or the annual stock verification. A recalled book must be returned within three working days of the recall notice; failure attracts the normal overdue fine from the recall return date.

5.6 **Material not issued for home lending.** The following are for in-library use only: reference books (encyclopaedias, handbooks, standards, dictionaries), the latest issues of journals and magazines, theses and dissertations, previous-year question paper volumes, and books marked "Reference".

5.7 **Overnight issue.** Copies marked "Overnight" (high-demand textbooks) may be borrowed after 16:00 and must be returned before 10:00 on the next working day. Late return of an overnight book attracts a fine of ₹20 per hour or part thereof, up to ₹200 per day.

5.8 **Semester-end limit for final-year students.** Final-semester students (BE and final-year PG) may not borrow books after 30 April 2027, except from the Reference Section for in-library use.

6. Overdue Fines, Lost and Damaged Material

6.1 Overdue fines are charged per book per calendar day after the due date, at the following rates.

Days overdue	Fine per book per day	Example
Day 1 to Day 7	₹2	A book returned 5 days late attracts ₹10
Day 8 to Day 30	₹5	A book returned 10 days late attracts ₹14 + ₹15 = ₹29
Day 31 onwards	₹10	–

6.2 The total overdue fine on a single book is capped at the current replacement cost of the book. Days on which the library is closed for more than three consecutive days (for example, a declared vacation) are not counted.

6.3 **Borrowing block.** A member with unpaid fines of more than ₹100, or with any book overdue by more than 30 days, cannot borrow, renew or reserve books until the dues are cleared.

6.4 **Payment.** Fines are paid online through the "Library Dues" option of the Student Portal (portal.spit.example) or at the Accounts Section counter. Cash is not accepted at the Circulation Counter. A receipt must be produced at the counter to clear the block on the same day; online payments are reflected automatically within one working day.

6.5 **Lost book.** A member who loses a book must report the loss in writing within 7 days of discovering it. The member may either (a) replace the book with a new copy of the same or a later edition within 30 days, plus a processing charge of ₹100, or (b) pay the current replacement cost of the book plus a processing charge of 20% of that cost. Overdue fines accrued up to the date of reporting the loss are payable in addition.

6.6 **Out-of-print books.** For a lost book that is out of print, the member pays three times the price printed in the accession register, or ₹1,000, whichever is higher, plus the 20% processing charge.

6.7 **Damaged material.** Marking, underlining, tearing pages or damaging the binding of library material will be treated as damage. Depending on the extent, the member will pay the binding cost or the full replacement cost as assessed by the Librarian. Deliberate mutilation or theft of material is a Category B offence under the Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules (SPIT-CA-COC-2026-01), in addition to recovery of the cost.

6.8 **Waiver.** The Librarian may waive overdue fines up to ₹500 in documented cases of medical hospitalisation of the member or bereavement in the immediate family. Requests for larger waivers are decided by the Library Advisory Committee.

7. Conduct in the Library

7.1 Members must show their identity card at the entry gate and must carry it at all times inside the library.

7.2 Bags, umbrellas and helmets must be left in the property counter at the entrance. The library is not responsible for valuables left in bags. Laptops, tablets and personal notebooks may be carried in.

7.3 Silence must be maintained in the Main Reading Hall, the Reference Section and the Silent Study Zone. Mobile phones must be on silent mode; phone calls are not permitted inside the reading areas.

7.4 Eating is not permitted anywhere in the library. Drinking water in closed, spill-proof bottles is allowed.

7.5 Seats may not be reserved by leaving books or belongings. Belongings left unattended for more than 30 minutes may be removed by staff and kept at the property counter.

7.6 Books taken from the shelves for reading must be left on the reading tables or the book trolleys and must not be re-shelved by members.

7.7 Members leaving the library may be asked to show the books and material they carry. The electronic security gates must not be bypassed.

7.8 Repeated breach of Sections 7.3 to 7.5 after a written warning may lead to suspension of library privileges for up to 15 days by the Librarian. Further breaches are referred to the Dean of Student Affairs under the Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules.

8. Group Discussion Rooms

8.1 The four Group Discussion Rooms may be booked by groups of three to six current students for project work, seminar preparation or group study.

8.2 Bookings are made through the "Room Booking" option in the library catalogue (OPAC) up to 3 days in advance. A slot is 2 hours long; one group may book a maximum of one slot per day and three slots per week.

8.3 If the group does not arrive within 15 minutes of the start of the slot, the booking is released to waiting users. A student who fails to turn up for booked slots three times in a semester loses booking privileges for the rest of that semester.

9. Electronic Resources and Remote Access

9.1 The library subscribes to the following electronic resources for 2026–27 (synthetic list for this research corpus).

Resource	Content	Access
IEEE Xplore digital library (institutional subscription)	IEEE journals, conference proceedings and standards	Campus network and remote access
ACM Digital Library	ACM journals and proceedings	Campus network and remote access
Springer engineering e-journals package	380 journals	Campus network and remote access
ScienceDirect engineering collection	270 journals	Campus network and remote access
E-book collection (approximately 7,500 titles)	Engineering and management e-books	Remote access
National digital library services	Open educational resources and theses	Open access
Institute repository "SPIT-IR"	B.Tech/M.Tech project reports, PhD theses, faculty publications	Campus network

9.2 **Remote access.** Students, faculty and PhD scholars can access subscribed e-resources from outside the campus through the library remote-access portal (remote.library.spit.example) using their institute e-mail credentials. Remote access is disabled for a member whose borrowing privileges are blocked under Section 6.3.

9.3 **Fair use.** Systematic or bulk downloading (for example, downloading an entire journal issue, or more than 50 articles from a single resource in one day), using download scripts, or sharing login credentials is prohibited. A publisher-reported violation will result in suspension of remote access for 30 days for a first instance; repeated violation is referred for action under the Code of Conduct and Disciplinary Rules.

9.4 **Digital Library usage.** Terminals in the Digital Library are for academic work only. Gaming, streaming entertainment content and installing software are not permitted. Printing is available at

₹2 per black-and-white page and ₹10 per colour page, charged to the student's print account on the Student Portal.

10. Similarity Check (Plagiarism Check) Service

10.1 The library provides a similarity-check service for theses, dissertations, project reports and manuscripts intended for publication, using licensed similarity-detection software.

10.2 A request is submitted by the student through the project guide or supervisor, by e-mail to library.similarity@spit.example. The report is sent to the guide within 3 working days.

10.3 Each UG project group is entitled to two free checks per project, each PG student to three free checks per dissertation and each PhD scholar to five free checks per thesis. Additional checks are charged at ₹200 per check.

10.4 The acceptable similarity level for submission of UG project reports and PG dissertations is up to 15%, excluding the bibliography, quoted material and the candidate's own previously published work properly cited. Reports above this level are returned to the guide for revision. Academic consequences of plagiarism are governed by the institute's academic regulations.

11. Book Bank Scheme

11.1 The Book Bank lends a complete set of prescribed textbooks for the entire semester to eligible students.

11.2 Eligible students are those admitted under the SC, ST, VJ/NT, OBC (non-creamy layer) or EWS categories, and students whose annual family income is below ₹8,00,000, on submission of a valid certificate.

11.3 Applications are made online through the Student Portal within the first 15 days of each semester. Book Bank books must be returned within 7 days of the last end-semester examination of that semester. Late return attracts the overdue fines in Section 6.1, calculated from the eighth day.

11.4 Book Bank sets are in addition to the normal borrowing limit in Section 4.3.

12. Suggestions for Purchase and Donations

12.1 Students and faculty may recommend books for purchase through the "Suggest a Book" form on the library catalogue. Recommendations received by 31 August are considered for the odd-semester purchase and those received by 31 December for the even-semester purchase.

12.2 Donations of books are accepted only if the books are relevant to the curriculum or research areas of the institute, were published within the last ten years (except classic texts) and are in good condition. The Librarian decides whether to accession a donated book.

13. Library No-Dues Clearance

13.1 A student must obtain library no-dues clearance (a) before the release of the final-semester grade card and (b) before applying for the Leaving Certificate, Transfer Certificate or refund of any caution or security deposit.

13.2 No-dues clearance is applied for online through the Student Portal. It is granted within 2 working days if the student has returned all books, including Book Bank books, and has no unpaid fines or lost-book charges.

13.3 Students vacating the hostel must also obtain library no-dues clearance before the hostel security deposit refund is processed, as stated in the Hostel Rules and Regulations (SPIT-CA-HST-2026-01).

14. Changes from the Previous Version

14.1 This version (4.0) supersedes SPIT-CA-LIB-2024-02 (Version 3.1). The principal changes are listed below.

Provision	Previous version 3.1 (2024–25)	This version 4.0 (2026–27)
UG borrowing limit	3 books for 14 days	4 books for 14 days
PG loan period	14 days	21 days
Overdue fine, Day 1–7	₹1 per day	₹2 per day
Overdue fine, Day 8 onwards	₹2 per day, no slab	₹5 per day (Day 8–30), ₹10 per day (Day 31 onwards)
Lost book processing charge	10% of replacement cost	20% of replacement cost
Borrowing block threshold	Unpaid fines above ₹200	Unpaid fines above ₹100 or any book overdue more than 30 days
Exam-period Reading Hall hours	08:00 – 22:00	08:00 – 23:00, including Sundays
24x7 Reading Room	Not available	Introduced (80 seats)
Group Discussion Room booking	Booked at the counter, 1-hour slots	Online booking, 2-hour slots, up to 3 days ahead
Similarity limit for UG/PG reports	20%	15%
Fine payment	Cash at Circulation Counter	Online via Student Portal or Accounts Section; no cash at counter

14.2 Fines accrued on books issued before 1 July 2026 are calculated at the old rates up to 30 June 2026 and at the new rates from 1 July 2026.

15. Contact

Purpose	Contact
Circulation, fines, membership	Circulation Counter, ground floor, Library Block; library@spit.example; extension 2201
E-resources and remote access	Digital Library desk; eresources@spit.example; extension 2205
Similarity check service	library.similarity@spit.example; extension 2206
Book Bank	Book Bank desk, ground floor; extension 2203
Librarian	Office of the Librarian, ground floor, Library Block; extension 2200

15.1 Complaints about library services that are not resolved by the Librarian within 7 working days may be raised under the Student Grievance Redressal Policy (SPIT-CA-GRV-2026-01).